

synchronises the data in your calendar, contacts, favorites, and tasks.

One thing you must refrain from doing is using the Pocket PC device until synchronization is complete. It is also possible to add more applications to be synchronised automatically when you connect your handheld to your PC.

Synchronization takes place on a continuous basis, but you also have the option for manual syncing. Synchronization will ensure that all your PIM information and other applications get synchronised constantly.

You can also set up more than one partnership. Suppose you use a PC at home and a laptop in the office, setting up multiple relationships will help you keep your Pocket PC device up-to-date with both.

However, it is not recommended to set up multiple partnerships until you have first mastered the art of using just one. After that you can set up as many multiple partnerships as you wish.

You've got mail

Your Pocket PC device also allows you to send and receive e-mail using the Inbox feature. Inbox synchronises with your PC and keeps the e-mail updated with those in your Pocket PC. It is very easy to add Inbox to your synchronization settings. Go to Tools > Options > Sync Options in your PC's ActiveSync and check Inbox. That should get your Inbox up and running.

You can write and store e-mail in your Pocket PC by launching Inbox from the Start menu. Click on New to get to the mail editor and compose your mail.

Use the Contacts button to select the name of the recipient from your address book. The next time you connect to your desktop PC, the mail will be sent automatically while syncing. It is the same with receiving e-mail. During synchronization, all the mail will be downloaded to your Pocket PC and you can read them on your own time.

There's a slight catch though. You can sync e-mail only from one PC, unlike other types of data such as appointments, files, etc. Multiple partnerships, therefore, would get you no where when it comes to using e-mail with Inbox. Another thing you have to keep in mind is the length of e-mail messages you want to receive. The default setting allows for 100 lines per e-mail.

If you want to see longer messages, you can set a maximum of 500 lines in Sync Settings in the Settings option. Remember to select the Include File Attachments options if you want to receive all your attachments.

On the Web and off it

Besides sending and receiving e-mail, you can also view offline Web pages on your Pocket PC

device, using AvantGo, an offline browser integrated in the Microsoft Pocket Internet Explorer. When surfing the Net on your handheld while it is connected to your computer, AvantGo.com caches these Web pages after down sampling the complexity of the Web pages, and transfers them to the device via your desktop PC the next time you synchronise.

You can specify the Web pages and browse through them offline. So make sure you include AvantGo in your Synchronization Settings, to make use of this feature.

Installing new goodies

Installing new software on your Pocket PC device is no big deal, provided you ensure that the file you are about to install is the right version for the Pocket PCs processor. Casio and Compaq make use of the MIPS type of processors whereas HP makes use of the SH3 type.

Check your device's manual if you're not sure of the processor type. Make sure that the program is the right one for your device if you don't want to get 'Wrong Device Type' messages. The next thing to do is to ensure that you have enough disk space and that you are connected to your PC.

Use ActiveSync to install the program from your PC. Click on ActiveSync on your Pocket PC device, run the installation file on your PC and set it up. The program will be automatically installed on your Pocket PC device. You can then run it using the program icon.

You can also copy compressed files with the .cab extension into the Pocket PC device using ActiveSync. Go to File Explorer in your Pocket PC and browse to the folder containing the particular file, click on it and set it up as per the instructions.

It is also possible to copy software in the form of .exe files directly to your Pocket PC device using ActiveSync. These files can be run directly without any installation.

The place where Microsoft's Pocket PC operating system really shines is with respect to multimedia. A decent resolution screen and better colour reproduction than most of the Palm devices around makes it great to display high resolution images.

You can also playback MP3 music and watch short movies and streaming video. Microsoft has recently released Windows Media Player 7.1 for the Pocket PC device, which you might want to download and install.

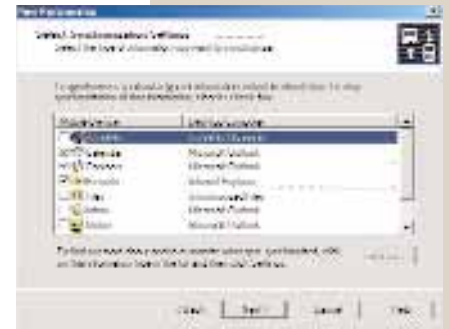
Looks like you're now all set to have some serious fun with your little handy man. So here's to a fruitful relationship with your new Pocket PC device! 📱

Always in sync

In the default synchronization settings, you can add more applications to be synchronized. Open ActiveSync in your PC. Select Options and then Tools. This brings up the synchronization box as shown in the image. Set as default the applications you want synchronized, and click Next. There you go!

Next time you connect your Pocket PC to your computer, the application you selected will also be synchronised.

The default synchronization settings ensure that your Pocket PC device and



your desktop sync on a continuous basis. It is possible to change the synchronizing interval. Go to Tools in ActiveSync, select Options and then Sync Mode. You will come across three options—On Connection, Manually, and Continuously. Selecting On Connection ensures that synchronization takes place only when the device is initially connected during a session. Choosing the Manually option ensures that synchronisation takes place only when you so desire. Continuously is the default option. Select the option you need.